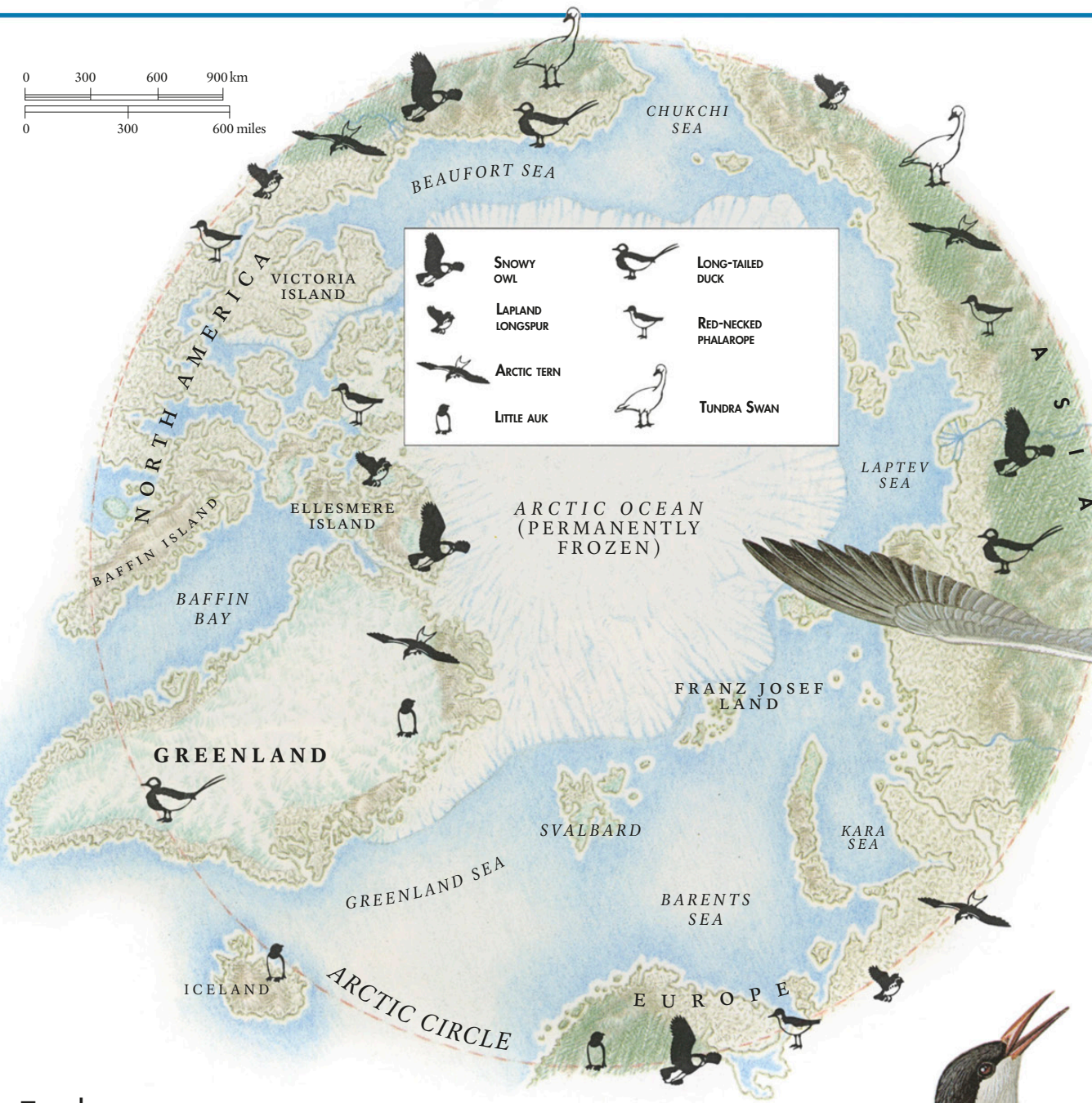
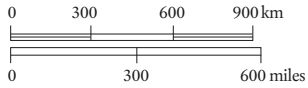


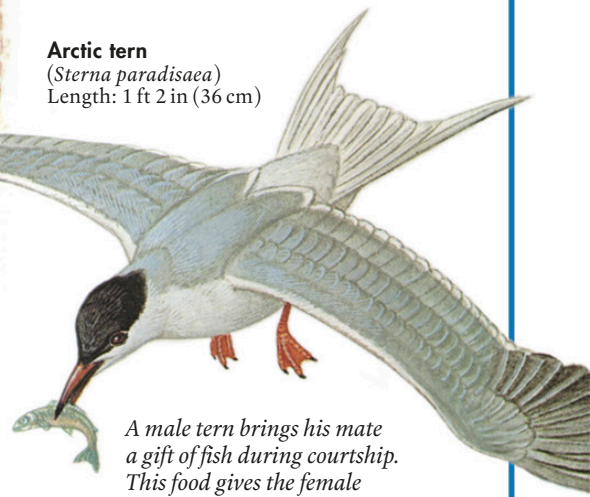


	SNOWY OWL		LONG-TAILED DUCK
	LAPLAND LONGSPUR		RED-NECKED PHALAROPE
	ARCTIC TERN		TUNDRA SWAN
	LITTLE AUKE		



In the tundra, the ground is always frozen just below the surface. A thin layer of soil above it freezes in winter and melts in summer. Water collects on the surface, forming lakes and swamps where waterbirds can feed.

Arctic tern
(*Sterna paradisaea*)
Length: 1 ft 2 in (36 cm)

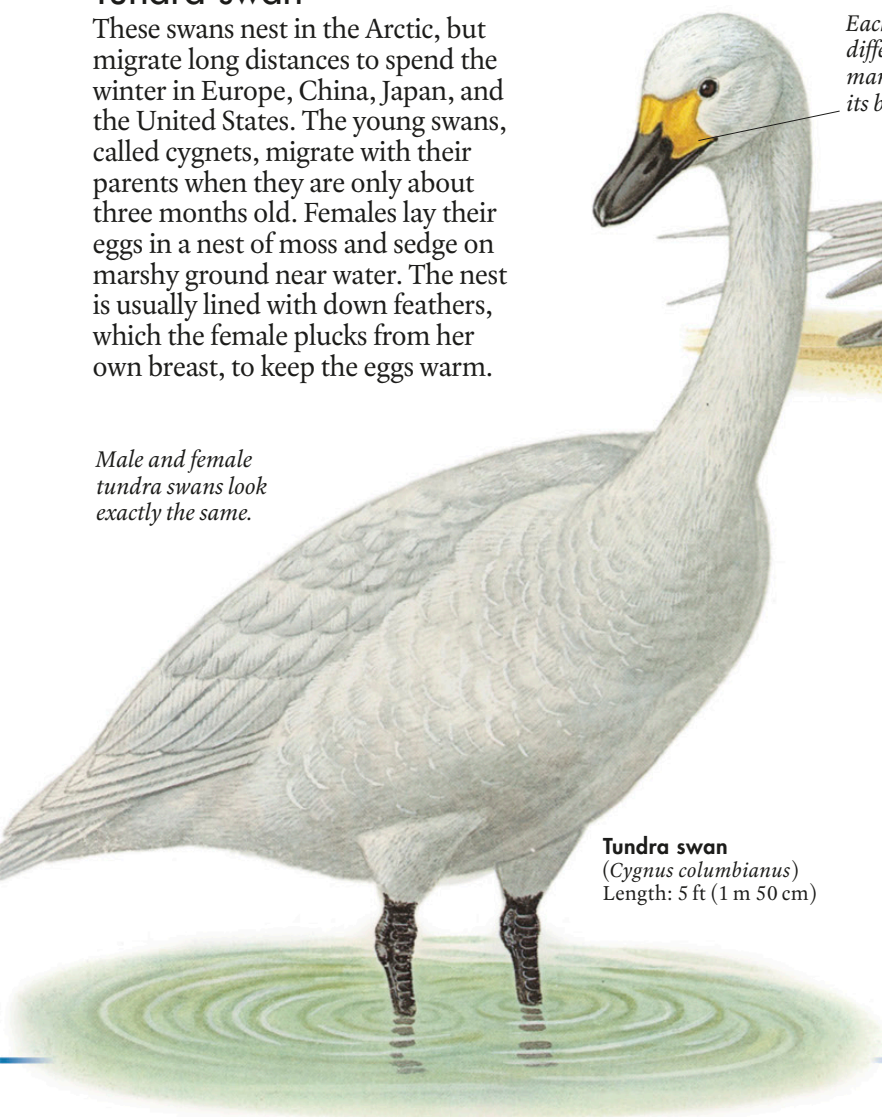


A male tern brings his mate a gift of fish during courtship. This food gives the female extra energy to help her form eggs.

Tundra swan

These swans nest in the Arctic, but migrate long distances to spend the winter in Europe, China, Japan, and the United States. The young swans, called cygnets, migrate with their parents when they are only about three months old. Females lay their eggs in a nest of moss and sedge on marshy ground near water. The nest is usually lined with down feathers, which the female plucks from her own breast, to keep the eggs warm.

Male and female tundra swans look exactly the same.



Tundra swan
(*Cygnus columbianus*)
Length: 5 ft (1 m 50 cm)

Each bird has different yellow markings on its bill.



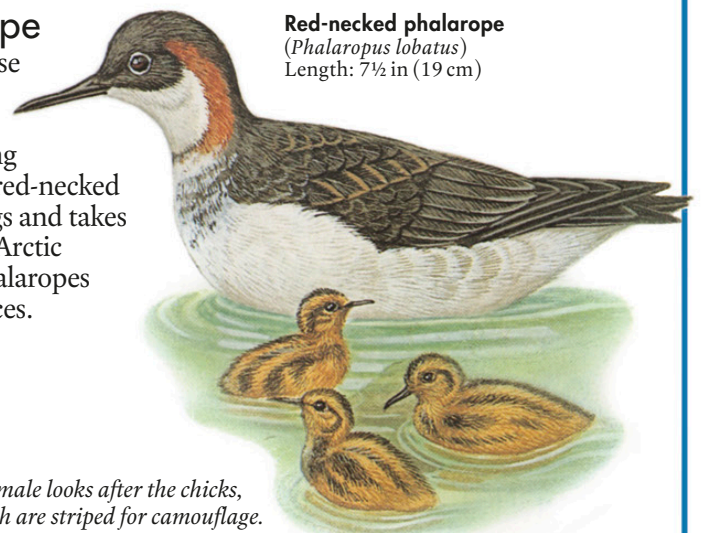
Arctic tern

These graceful and elegant fliers travel further than any other bird. Arctic terns raise their young in the Arctic summer. When fall arrives, they fly right down to the Antarctic where summer is just beginning. This involves a round trip of about 25,000 miles (40,000 km) each year. They nest in large colonies and help each other drive away attackers, dive-bombing enemies such as Arctic foxes, or pecking at their heads.

Red-necked phalarope

This is an unusual bird because the female has more brightly colored feathers than the male and takes the lead during courtship. It is also the male red-necked phalarope that sits on the eggs and takes care of the chicks. When the Arctic winter sets in, red-necked phalaropes migrate south to warmer places.

Red-necked phalarope
(*Phalaropus lobatus*)
Length: 7½ in (19 cm)



The male looks after the chicks, which are striped for camouflage.